



Language interpretation
Microsoft has announced that Teams meeting attendees can now have an interpreter. <https://digit.in/oct22-49>

Qualcomm

Ultra high SD 8 Gen 2
Reports suggest that Qualcomm SD 8 Gen 2 may have ultra-high frequency variant. <https://digit.in/oct22-50>

tech

REVIEWS

POCO M5

Chic and formidable

The Poco M5 is an affordable phone priced under ₹15,000 in India and is packed to the brim with essential features. Though the Poco M5 is a 4G phone, it's got all the bases covered with features such as the 50MP main camera, a large 5,000mAh battery to boot and an unmatched design in this price range. In this Poco M5 review, we'll try and find out whether buying the Poco M5 4G makes sense or over a 5G device.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Right out of the box, the Poco M5 feels nothing like an affordable smartphone as it has a leather-like textured finish on the back panel which gives it a premium look and feel. The Poco M5 isn't the slimmest or lightest smartphone in this price range yet it's one of the best-looking phones you can get under ₹15,000. Even though it's largely made from plastic, the Poco M5 is durable for daily use and the screen upfront has a layer of Gorilla Glass 3 protection.

DISPLAY

The Poco M5 features a good display that's perfect for watching videos and much more. It supports a 90Hz refresh rate which makes every interaction smooth and helps while playing games. It has a waterdrop notch and a rather wide chin but that doesn't come in the way of your viewing experience. In our tests, the display of the Poco M5 produced 360 nits of maximum brightness. Being an LCD panel, the minimum brightness we recorded was 2 nits. It produces accurate colours and is vibrant with crisp visuals which are good enough for most users but an AMOLED display here would have uplifted the viewing experience.

PERFORMANCE

The MediaTek Helio G99 inside the Poco M5 is no slouch in day-to-day

performance and easily keeps up with day to day tasks. In benchmark tests, the Helio G99 showcased similar, if not better CPU and GPU performance over the Helio G96, Snapdragon 695, 680 and the Dimensity 810 chipsets. The thermal management has also improved on the Helio G99 from the G96. Game Turbo 5.0 keeps games like COD Mobile and Genshin Impact running albeit with some frame drops here and there but nothing that's going to spoil your overall experience. We also ran the CPU throttling test where the Poco M5 delivered 94% of its maximum potential in the 15-minute run and 92% in the 30-minute run. This proves that it's more than capable of handling daily tasks without compromising much.

BATTERY LIFE

The Poco M5 has a large and sufficient battery capacity of 5,000mAh to boot which offers a long battery life. The battery life of the Poco M5 is really great and a major plus point for buyers because it can last for over two days on

casual use. If you're a power user, you'll be able to get around a day's worth of battery life on a single charge. Moreover, the M5's battery didn't even drop by a per cent for 10 hours the phone was kept idle.

CAMERAS

In adequate lighting conditions, the Poco M5 produces sharp and visually appealing pictures from its main 50MP camera. The images have a nice and natural depth of field and the camera app locks down the focus quickly. The textures in subjects such as flowers or walls are also well processed as it doesn't smooth out the pictures. The portrait mode works well, lending a shallow depth of field effect to pictures but loses out a bit on textures and natural colours. At night, the pictures from the main camera have a lot of grain and artefacts and switching to the night mode solves those issues as it reduces the noise and bumps up the highlights and exposure levels. The macro camera takes decent close-up shots and nothing extraordinary because the sensor is of a low resolution which is only able to capture so many details.

VERDICT

The Poco M5 is one of the most good-looking phones you can buy without emptying your pockets. It's got a good display, a powerful processor in the Helio G99 which handles everyday use easily and a great primary camera.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.5-inch LCD, FHD+, 90Hz refresh rate, Gorilla Glass 3 | THICKNESS: 8.9mm | WEIGHT: 201g | PLATFORM: MediaTek Helio G99 | RAM: 4GB/6GB LPDDR4X | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 64GB/128GB UFS 2.2 | EXPANDABLE STORAGE: Yes, upto 1TB | 5G SUPPORT: No | USB-C: Yes | 3.5MM JACK: Yes | OS: MIUI 13 based on Android 12 | REAR CAMERA: 50MP (f/1.8) + 2MP macro + 2MP depth sensor | REAR CAMERA VIDEO: 1080p (30FPS) | FRONT CAMERA: 8MP (f/2.0) | SPEAKERS: Single speaker | BATTERY AND CHARGING: 5,000mAh, 18W wired | COLOURS: Poco Yellow, Power Black, Icy Blue

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